3.2 Methods of Cooking

Aim: To formulate and prepare recipes using the following methods of cooking in order to understand the procedure.

Equipment needed: Pressure pan, sauce pan, kadai, spatula, vessels and steamer.

Cooking: Food preparation is an important step in meeting the nutritional needs of the family. The process of subjecting food to the action of heat is termed as cooking. Heat is transferred to the food by conduction, convection, radiation or microwave energy.

Cooking takes place by moist and dry heat methods. Moist heat involves water and steam. Air or fat are used in dry heat methods.

Procedure

A. Steaming – Idli

- Take 1-2 glass of water in the steamer and bring it to boil
- Grease idli moulds and pour batter into it.



▲ Plate 3.4 Steaming

- Place moulds in the steamer
- Cover steamer with a lid
- Steam the idlis for 10 minutes over medium flame.

B. Blanching - Tomatoes

- Boil a pot of water.
- Remove from fire
- Add 4-5 tomatoes to the boiling water
- Allow 2-3 minutes and remove from the boiling water.
- Put the tomatoes in ice water.
- Remove the tomatoes from the ice water and peel skin.



▲ Plate 3.5 Blanching

C. Poaching - Egg

- Boil water in a sauce pan.
- Break an egg in the centre; slide the contents into the boiling water.
- Cook for three minutes and remove from water.

D. Deep fat frying - Poori

- Heat oil in a deep fat frying pan or kadai.

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